

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 7 3

♥ Q J T 8 2

♦ K 8 6

♣ Q 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K Q J 4 2

♥ K 5

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 1
[show NS] SOUTH's 2♦ bid is New Minor Forcing.

SOUTH chose ♦s rather than ♣s simply because the ♦s were stronger.

Board 2
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ J 8 4
 ♥ K Q 8 4
 ♦ Q 5 2
 ♣ 7 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 5
 ♥ A J 9 6 2
 ♦ A K
 ♣ J 8 5 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	3 ♥		
All Pass			
3 ♥ by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 2

[show NS] SOUTH is unlikely to win 10 tricks if NORTH has three ♣ losers.

SOUTH's 3 ♣ bid is a Help Suit Game try. With no help in ♣s and no ruffing values, NORTH's 8 points are not enough to think of game, so NORTH signs off in 3 ♥.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul



♠ A J 7 6 2
♥ K T 9 4
♦ K Q 6
♣ 4

N

W E

S

♠ K 8
♥ Q 8 5
♦ J 8 4
♣ A K J 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	3 ♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 3
[show NS] SOUTH's 3 ♦ bid is Fourth Suit Forcing
and does NOT show a ♦ stopper.

The bid asks NORTH to further describe her hand.
NORTH does not have a rebiddable suit, but does
have ♦s stopped so she bids 3NT.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ Q 9 6 5 2

♥ 7 6 3

♦ A Q

♣ Q 8 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 7

♥ A Q 5

♦ K T 9 4 3

♣ K T 7

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2NT

All Pass
2NT by South

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 4

[show NS] NORTH cannot rebid the 5-card ♠ suit, cannot support SOUTH's ♦ s, and cannot bid Notrump without a ♥ stopper.

So she bids 3♣, New Minor Forcing, asking SOUTH to describe his hand further.

SOUTH doesn't have three ♠s, nor does he have four ♥s. But he does have ♥s stopped, so bids 2NT. North is not strong enough to bid game so she passes.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A K T 6 2

♥ A 4 3

♦ K 9 6 4

♣ 7

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ Q 5 4 3

♥ 7 5

♦ A J T 3

♣ 6 5 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♦	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass 4 ♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 5
[show NS] NORTH's 3 ♦ bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH has excellent help in ♦s so with 8 points he bids the game.

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ Q J 8 3

♥ A Q J 7

♦ J 9

♣ K T 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A T 5

♥ T 4

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ A 8 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 6

[show NS] NORTH has no reason to consider New Minor Forcing with this hand.

SOUTH does not have four ♥s or he would have already supported, and he does not have four ♠s or he would not have bid 1NT.

So NORTH should bid the Notrump game.

Board 7

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 6 4
 ♥ K Q 9 7 4
 ♦ 4
 ♣ A J 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 9 7 2
 ♥ 8 5
 ♦ A 9 6
 ♣ Q T 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 7

[show NS] SOUTH might well bid 3NT at his second turn, and this may turn out to be the final contract anyway.

But it doesn't hurt to bid 2 ♦ (Fourth Suit Forcing) just to see if NORTH happens to have three ♠s. She does, so 4 ♠ becomes the better game.

Board 8
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A K 7 6 3

♥ K T 8 4

♦ K 4

♣ 5 2

♠ 8 5

♥ Q J 9 7

♦ A Q 9

♣ A 8 4 3

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 8
[show NS] SOUTH isn't strong enough to make a Reverse bid of 2♥ at his second turn.

NORTH uses the 2♦ (NMF) bid to ask SOUTH for further description. SOUTH should first show a 4-card ♥ suit, and next show 3-card ♠ support.

Change SOUTH's ♥9 to the ♠9 and the contract would be 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Board 9
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K 9 4 2

♥ 8

♦ 8 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 9 7

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A Q J T 7

♥ 7 6 5

♦ 3

♣ A K 8 4

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 9
[show NS] SOUTH's 3♥ bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

NORTH barely had enough strength to respond in the first place, but revaluing the hand, (and particularly the singleton ♥), makes it worth a raise to game.

Board 10
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A J 7 5

♥ K 6

♦ 8 7 4

♣ A J T 3

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K T

♥ A 9 7 5 4

♦ K Q 6 2

♣ 9 6

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 10
[show NS] NORTH has no reason to consider Fourth Suit Forcing with this hand.

SOUTH does not have four ♠s or he would have already supported.

So NORTH should bid the Notrump game.

Board 11

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 7

♥ Q T 9 7 6

♦ Q 7

♣ A T 9 6

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ J 8 3

♥ A 8 3 2

♦ K 8 6 4

♣ 7 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥

All Pass
2 ♥ by North

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 11
[show NS] NORTH should pass 2 ♥. She is not strong enough to try for game.

Board 12
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K Q T 6 3

♥ K Q J 8

♦ 9 5

♣ Q 8

♠ 8 4

♥ A T 7

♦ Q T 6 4 3

♣ A K 2

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 12
[show NS] NORTH knows there should be game, but doesn't know whether it will be 4♠, 4♥ or 3NT. To find out which she uses NMF and bids 2♣ at her second turn.

SOUTH does not have a 4-card ♥ suit, nor does he have three ♠s, but he does have ♣s stopped so he bids 2NT, which North raises to 3NT.

Board 13
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A J

♥ K Q J 8 4

♦ A 5

♣ J 5 4 2

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K 5 3

♥ T 9 5 3

♦ 9 8 6 4

♣ K Q

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 13
[show NS] NORTH cannot see a game unless
SOUTH has help in ♣s so she makes a Help Suit
Game Try.

SOUTH has 8 points and the doubleton ♣ K Q so he
bids the game.

Board 14
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 9 8 5

♥ J 7 4

♦ K Q T 3

♣ A K 5

N

W E

S

♠ A J T

♥ A Q T 3

♦ 9 4

♣ Q J 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 14
[show NS] NORTH has a perfect hand on which to use Fourth Suit Forcing. If South can stop ♠s, then 3NT would be a great contract.

There is one problem - if NORTH bids 1♠ at her second turn it is NOT considered FSF, so she must jump to 2♠.

SOUTH, win a fine ♠ stopper, bids 3NT.

Board 15
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ Q 7 5

♥ J T 7 6

♦ A 8

♣ K Q J 3

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K 8 4 3 2

♥ K Q 8 3

♦ 7 3

♣ A 5

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 15
[show NS] SOUTH's 2♦ bid is a perfect example of NMF. It provides NORTH with the opportunity to show either a 4-card ♥ suit, OR 3-card ♠ support.

In this hand NORTH actually has both. When that happens, showing the ♥s is first priority.

Board 16
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K J 9 7

♥ 8 7

♦ A K J 6 2

♣ T 2

♠ Q T 8 3

♥ A K 6 5

♦ T

♣ A 9 8 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 16
[show NS] NORTH's 1♠ bid is definitely forcing, but it is not FSF. In this one instance, all bids at the one level, the ♠ bid shows a real suit.

So SOUTH shows the 4-card support and NORTH bids game.

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A 6 4
♥ A K 9 7 2
♦ 7
♣ K 8 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 7
♥ Q 6 5 3
♦ T 8 3
♣ A J 7 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 17

[show NS] NORTH could make a Help Suit Game
Try in either ♠s or ♣s. But she doesn't need the ♠
help as much as she does in ♣s, so she chooses ♣s.

SOUTH doesn't have a strong hand but has excellent
help in ♣s so he bids the game.

Board 18

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q 6
 ♥ K J 8 5
 ♦ A 9 8 5 4
 ♣ K 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J T 5
 ♥ T 9 6
 ♦ K 7
 ♣ A Q J 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♦	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 18

[show NS] Could NORTH bid 2♥, (FSF), even though she actually has the suit?

Perhaps, but there is no reason to do so. SOUTH does not have four ♥s or he would have mentioned them before bidding ♠s.

NORTH should ignore the ♥ suit and bid 3NT.

Board 19
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ Q 5 4

♥ 7 6

♦ A K 9 8

♣ A 8 7 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A K T 6 3

♥ K Q 9 8 5

♦ 6 3

♣ 5

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 19
[show NS] SOUTH cannot bid 2♥ at his second turn; that would be Fourth Suit Forcing and wouldn't show the ♥ suit at all.

With a game-forcing two-suiter he jumps to 3♥ instead. NORTH recognizes that SOUTH must hold five ♠s and bids the ♠ game.

Board 20

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 7 6
 ♥ K J 8 7 3
 ♦ A 9 4
 ♣ 9 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 8 5
 ♥ A 5
 ♦ K Q J 6 2
 ♣ 6 4 3

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
All Pass			
2♦ by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 20

[show NS] NORTH bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing, hoping SOUTH has three ♥s.

SOUTH does not have three ♥s and he has no other bid to make that will describe his hand any better. He cannot bid Notrump again without a ♣ stopper. So SOUTH rebids the 5-card ♦ suit.

NORTH has nowhere to go, so passes.

Board 21

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 8 4

♥ A K 9 4 3

♦ A J 9 6

♣ 7 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A Q J 6 3

♥ Q J 5

♦ K 4

♣ T 9 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 21
[show NS] SOUTH should not use Fourth Suit
Forcing to see if NORTH holds three ♠s because
that information is irrelevant.

SOUTH already knows there is an 8-card ♥ fit and
enough points to be in game so he bids it.

Board 22
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -
♥ -
♦ -
♣ -

♠ Q 9 3
♥ 7 6 4 2
♦ K T 8 2
♣ Q 5

N

W E

S

♠ A K J 8 6
♥ J 5 3
♦ 3
♣ A K 6 3

♠ -
♥ -
♦ -
♣ -

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	3 ♠		
All Pass			
3 ♠ by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 22
[show NS] SOUTH thinks there might be game if NORTH can help with the three ♥ losers. So he bids 3♥ as a Help Suit Game Try.

NORTH cannot provide any help at all, so quickly signs off in 3♠ which SOUTH passes.

Board 23

North Deals

None Vul

♠ —



♣ —

♠ K 9 5

♥ K J 2

♦ A 9 6 3

♣ Q 6 4



♠ —



♣ —

♠ A J 8 6 2

♥ Q 9 3

◆ K 7 4

♣ 8 5

West

North

East

South

1♦

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♠

All Pass
2♠ by S

All Pass 2♠ by South

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 23

[show NS] SOUTH bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing, hoping NORTH will show three ♠s.

NORTH does show three ♠s, but also shows a minimum hand so South passes.

Board 24

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K T 7
 ♥ A K 6 5 2
 ♦ J 9 8
 ♣ Q 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 9 5
 ♥ T 4
 ♦ K Q 7 4
 ♣ K J 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-AdvancedForcing 24

[show NS] NORTH wants to be in game but doesn't know which one. If SOUTH holds three ♥s she would prefer 4♥, otherwise she would try 3NT. NORTH bids 2♠, Fourth Suit Forcing.

SOUTH denies three ♥s but confirms a ♠ honor by bidding 2NT, so NORTH bids the game in Notrump.